

Dylan Neal

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Chicago, IL

Full-Stack Software Engineer with hands-on experience building and shipping production-ready web applications across the frontend and backend using React, Next.js, TypeScript, Node.js runtimes, PostgreSQL, and cloud services. Experienced in end-to-end ownership, from application architecture and relational schema design to API development, background processing, authentication, and CI/CD pipelines. Strong at balancing speed and quality in fast-moving environments, with a product-minded approach to scalable, maintainable software.

Professional Experience

Clarity Lab

Full Stack Software Engineer | Remote | April 2023 - Present

- Designed and shipped a production-ready full-stack web platform using React 18, TypeScript, and modern frontend architecture, with responsive UX and SEO-ready content delivery.
- Own end-to-end implementation decisions across UI architecture, routing, component design, and frontend performance optimization.
- Built reusable UI systems and shared styling primitives (CSS Modules + custom properties) to support maintainability and consistent behavior across pages/features.
- Developed interactive data/article navigation features (sticky TOC, section tracking via Intersection Observer, smooth scrolling) to improve usability for long-form content.
- Engineered a custom canvas-based particle animation with dual particle systems, sine-wave twinkling, mouse repulsion, scroll parallax, and depth based rendering; optimized with AnimationFrame, useCallback, and responsive particle count scaling for mobile performance.

Intel 471

Software Engineer - Intern | Remote | July 2022 - December 2022

- Developed and documented bidirectional API integrations to support accurate, timely dissemination of threat intelligence data to external platforms. Deployed API's via Microsoft Azure.
- Built reliable data ingestion and transformation pipelines supporting structured event-driven workflows
- Diagnosed production issues, implemented fixes, and improved system robustness.

Apple

Technical Specialist, Genius Bar | Chicago, IL | September 2021 - September 2022

- Provided direct public-facing support in a high-volume environment, explaining complex technical issues in accessible language to build trust and understanding.
- Responded to sensitive customer concerns with professionalism, accuracy, and adherence to institutional policies and privacy requirements.
- Educated customers on device usage, system behavior, and best practices, emphasizing clarity and informed decision-making.

Education

Master of Science in Software Engineering

DePaul University | March 2025

Concentration: Software Architecture and Development

Relevant Coursework:

Real-Time Software Architecture, Machine Learning Applications, Enterprise Software Applications, DevOps, Data Structures & Algorithms, Database Systems, Global Software Development, Agile Methodologies

Bachelors of Fine Arts with Honors Distinction

The School of The Art Institute of Chicago (SAIC) | May 2018

Primary Focus: Computer Graphics and Web Design

Emphasis on information design, digital storytelling, and research-based conceptualizations.

Honors distinction awarded for academic and creative excellence

Relevant Technical Skills

Languages: Typescript, JavaScript, HTML5, CSS3, SQL

Frontend: React 18, Next.js, React Router, Tailwind CSS, Vite, CSS Modules, Responsive Design

Backend & Architecture: Node.js, Next.js API Routes, REST APIs, Server Actions, Authentication, event driven workflows

Tooling and DevOps: Git, GitHub Actions, API Testing (Postman, Insomnia) environment variable management

Database & ORM: PostgreSQL, Prisma ORM, Neon Serverless Postgres, Prisma migrations, connection pooling